

WIRING INTO THE FUTURE
School students attend an experiment at Shri Vishwakarma Skill University in Palwal, Haryana

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

million professionals with digital skills, and approximately 50 per cent of the current workforce will need to reskill itself in emerging tech.

Firms today are taking a 'skill-based' rather than a 'degree-based' approach. Core employability skills that have taken precedence over degrees include critical thinking, problem-solving, teamwork and collaboration and time management.

To address the skills shortage, India needs to improve the quality of education and training to align skills with the demands of the evolving economy. There is now a wide mismatch between the skills that employers need and the skills that job-seekers possess. That's why the government should encourage more partnerships and collaborations among industry, educational institutes and government agencies to push for skilling in emerging technologies.

At its own end, the Government has taken several initiatives such as Skill India Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana, SANKALP, STRIVE, National Policy on Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, Indian Skill Development Service, National Programme on Technology Enhanced Learning and National Digital Literacy Mission. With the Companies Act, 2013 making skill development mandatory under Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) activities, private organisations have been addressing the issue too. In fact, the demand for skill-up courses in Tier II and III cities surged by almost 50 per cent last year. Budget 2023 focused on youth upskilling and research and development to make India the "skill capital of the world". While these are welcome steps, their on-ground implementation holds the key. Creative skills need to be integrated with technological skills to prepare the workforce for the future. That demands a massive restructuring of skill learning and training. ■

SHRI VISHWAKARMA SKILL UNIVERSITY, HARYANA

↘ One of India's oldest skills university offers a variety of courses, from hospitality management to graphics design

TEAMLEASE SKILLS UNIVERSITY, VADODARA

↘ Courses offered include commerce and management, mechatronics, life skills, and industry and knowledge partnerships